



Policy

Results Acknowledgement and Communication

Scope

Site	Service/Department/Unit	Disciplines
SCGOPHCG	Organisation Wide	All Staff

Introduction

Patient safety and quality of care at Sir Charles Gairdner Osborne Park Health Care Group (SCGOPHCG) relies on appropriate clinical investigation and testing. All pathology and radiological relating to patients of SCGOPHCG must be reviewed by an appropriate member of the treating clinical team and acted upon appropriately.

Risk Statement

Non-compliance with this policy will:

Breach legislative requirements	☐	Impact on Patient Quality of Care	☒
Breach National/State/Hospital Policy	☒	Impact on Patient Safety	☒
Breach professional standards	☐	Misconduct	☐
Breach SCGOPHCG Mission & Values	☐	Staff Safety	☐
Other:	☐		

Responsibilities

This policy applies to all staff with responsibility for ordering, reviewing and actioning pathology and radiological results.

Clinical Governance for all clinical investigations for inpatients and outpatients lies with the treating consultant unless;

- There has been a transfer of care to another specialty; and/or
- The Head of Department specifically defines alternative governance.

The consultant responsible for the patient must have systems in place for their patients to ensure that:

- Unnecessary clinical investigations are avoided.
- Each abnormal result is acted upon in a clinically appropriate time.

It is the responsibility of the person ordering the investigation to ensure that;

- All results are followed up.
- The requested investigations are clearly documented in iSoft Clinical Manager (iCM).
- Each result for patients under their care is acknowledged and tracked.

- At any point in the process when the patient care is transferred to a different treating team, a formal clinical / medical handover is to be verbally provided and documented within the patient medical record.

These systems apply to tests ordered for all categories of patients.

Procedure

Each treating medical team must put systems in place for tracking patients on iCM for whom tests have been ordered. These systems apply to tests ordered for all categories of patients (Inpatients, Outpatients, recently discharged patients etc.).

At any point in the process when the patient care is transferred to a different treating team, a formal clinical / medical handover is to be verbally provided and documented within the patient medical record.

Urgent and Critical PathWest Laboratory Test Results

PathWest Laboratories will telephone test results for both inpatients and outpatients that:

- Are deemed to be **critical**
- Have been designated as **urgent** or to be phoned to the requesting medical officer without delay.

If the requesting clinician or the clinician responsible for the patient at the time cannot be reached, the on-call registrar or on-call consultant from the clinical unit that requested the test or was the clinical team responsible for the care of the patient at the time of discharge will be notified.

Any Doctor receiving a critical or abnormal result notification via telephone call (or their delegated authority) must document any clinical decision making and/or action arising from the investigation result in the patient medical records.

Compliance, monitoring and evaluation

Each Medical Head of Department is responsible for monitoring compliance with this policy.

Periodic audits will be conducted to evaluate the effectiveness of this policy.

Related Documents

[SCGOPHCG Clinical Handover - Communicating for Policy](#)

Authorisation & Version Control

Policy Sponsor:	SCGOPHCG Area Director Clinical Services			
Policy Contact:	Deputy Director Medical Services			
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Applicable Standards	NSQHS Standard 1: Clinical Governance  , NSQHS Standard 2: Partnering with Consumers  , NSQHS Standard 6: Communicating for Safety 			